

Chicago Tribune



QUESTIONS? CALL 1-800-TRIBUNE

SATURDAY, JUNE 21, 2025

BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

‘Safety valve’ for state budget

\$100M

Lawmakers have designed a flexible fund of \$100 million that Gov. JB Pritzker can use to cover gaps left by unrealized federal funding. The “safety valve” pulls from about 50 existing funds that weren’t being fully used, Illinois Comptroller Susana Mendoza. says

Amid federal funding uncertainty, lawmakers add a few levers to pull in case of fiscal emergencies

By Olivia Olander
Chicago Tribune

Illinois lawmakers grappling with uncertainty over Trump administration spending cuts tucked a handful of tools aimed at maintaining key programs into the budget package signed by Gov. JB

Pritzker earlier this week, including a flexible fund of \$100 million the governor can use to cover gaps left by unrealized federal funding. “The magnitude and volume of problems that Trump and his administration are creating is something that no state has ever dealt with before. So it will have

limited use,” Andy Manar, the deputy governor on budget issues, said of the \$100 million fund. “But it will serve a very strategic role.” The state has also expanded the state treasurer’s authority to lend up to \$2 billion to the comptroller to pay bills, building on emergency lending powers used during the budget impasse of former Gov. Bruce Rauner, as well as expanded payroll protections for state workers funded by federal grants.

Pritzker has said since President Donald Trump’s inauguration that the state can’t make up for multi-billion federal funding shortfalls, although the scope of those cuts remains unclear as federal budget negotiations led by Republicans are ongoing in Washington, D.C. The measures signed this month are intended to bridge gaps this year and begin to address the \$1.8

Turn to Budget, Page 4



CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SAY IT’S SOSA

Former Cubs legend Sammy Sosa receives applause from fans as he waves from a suite at Wrigley Field during a game against the Mariners on Friday. The slugger, whose race with Mark McGwire for the home run record in 1998 made him a national figure, returned to Wrigley for the first time since his controversial exit in 2004. Sosa previously reunited with the organization in January at the Cubs Convention after a decadeslong rift fueled by his alleged use of performance-enhancing drugs. **Coverage in Chicago Sports**

In Deerfield, ‘Ritz-Carlton for dogs’ all oohs, paws

By Robert Channick
Chicago Tribune

A luxury hotel is coming to Deerfield and its guests may be among the most exclusive on the North Shore. To start with, they’ll need four paws and a tail, and perhaps a well-heeled owner. K9 Resorts, a national pet hotel chain which bills itself as the Ritz-Carlton for dogs, is opening its first Illinois location Monday in Deerfield. The facility features individual suites with high-definition TVs tuned 24/7 to DogTV and Animal Planet, premium shampoos in its bathingsalons, antimicrobial play areas, an air purification system and of course, room service. “We believe in elevating pet care to almost human-grade hospitality, hotel quality,” said Nehme Abouzeid, executive vice president and chief marketing officer of Luxury Pet Hotel Investments, a K9 Resorts investor and franchisee launching the Deerfield location. “We like to say that we’re a hotel, and our guests just happen to be dogs.” Located in a former Mexican restaurant on a Home Depot

Turn to Hotel, Page 2



Eileen Cazares walks past the Gale Street Inn in Chicago on Friday. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

‘Anchor’ of Jefferson Park closes

Gale Street known for some of city’s best ribs

By Rebecca Johnson and Sophie Levenson
Chicago Tribune

George Karzas kept his cards close to his chest. At Weston’s Coffee, where he often orders a blueberry muffin and drip coffee with room for cream, the baristas had no idea the longtime restaurant owner planned to close Gale Street Inn. Nor did his many customers in and around Jefferson Park. “It’s too soon to talk,” Karzas

said Friday from the bright red doorway of his restaurant at 4914 N. Milwaukee Ave. He has kept the door locked since Wednesday night. Karzas announced on Instagram Thursday that Gale Street Inn, a neighborhood staple in operation since 1963, was permanently closed, a troubling trend among local restaurants, industry professionals say. He cited staffing shortages as the primary reason for the abrupt closure. “Hiring and retaining quality staff has proven too tough for too long,” he wrote. “We are tired of sucking, we have standards

you know. But overworking our existing crew is not the answer. There are simply too many of you and not enough of us.” He went on to say in the post that he’s loved operating in Chicago, “the greatest food town on the planet,” and that there is “no gracious way to close a retail business.” The restaurant is widely known for its signature baby back ribs. Some locals are mourning the loss of the restaurant. Konrad Klima, who was born and raised in Jefferson Park, had been having a tough day and was

Turn to Closes, Page 4

Judge weighs Guard in LA

Briefings requested while troops remain in Trump’s control

By Olga R. Rodriguez
Associated Press

LOS ANGELES — California’s challenge of the Trump administration’s military deployment in Los Angeles returned to a federal courtroom in San Francisco on Friday for a brief hearing after an appeals court handed President Donald Trump a key procedural win. U.S. District Judge Charles Breyer put off issuing any additional rulings and instead asked for briefings from both sides by noon Monday on whether the Posse Comitatus Act, which prohibits troops from conducting civilian law enforcement on U.S. soil, is being violated in Los Angeles. The hearing happened the day after the 9th Circuit appellate panel allowed the president to keep control of National Guard troops he deployed in response to protests over immigration raids. California Gov. Gavin Newsom said in his complaint that “violation of the Posse Comitatus Act is imminent, if not already underway,” but Breyer last week postponed considering that allegation. Vice President JD Vance, a Marine veteran, traveled to Los Angeles on Friday and met with troops, including U.S. Marines who have been deployed to protect federal buildings. Vance said the court found Trump’s determination to send in federal troops “was legitimate,” and he will do it again if necessary.

Turn to Guard, Page 6

INSIDE Dangerous heat on way to Chicago

Chicagoans can expect intense heat compounded by muggy humidity beginning Saturday and continuing for the next several days. The heat can turn deadly, city officials stressed, as daytime temperatures may reach 97 degrees on Saturday, with a peak afternoon heat index of 106, according to the National Weather Service. **Chicagoland, Page 4**

IRAN TALKS: A meeting between Iran’s foreign minister and top European diplomats Friday yielded hopes of further talks but no indication of any immediate breakthrough. **Nation & World**

